

Module Scope Ceiling

Stage 1 status update & feedback request

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Motivating Cases

Updates external to this proposal:

- Severity of supply-chain security concerns
- Support from 1Password

1Password × LavaMoat

The future of our supply chain security

1Password is a password manager trusted by millions of families and businesses to store their secrets. In building our browser extension and product generally, we depend on a large third-party JavaScript dependency tree.

We are currently exploring LavaMoat's:

1. **Install-time protection:** LavaMoat allows us to prevent arbitrary script execution during package installs, ensuring that third-party scripts cannot execute code on developer machines or CI runners without explicit approval.
2. **Build-time compartmentalization:** We are exploring running parts of our build processes inside LavaMoat's SES-based compartments. Each dependency has access to only the globals and built-ins its policy permits, so packages cannot access e.g. the filesystem or network beyond what is allowed.

For a security-focused product like 1Password, the integrity of our build process is as critical as the integrity of the shipped artifact. LavaMoat gives us a meaningful layer of defense here today and is what we're also looking to as the future of supply-chain security.

How standards help LavaMoat and us: LavaMoat currently relies on a SES shim and uses string-based evaluation and `with` statements to construct compartments. Language support for compartmentalization would provide a better foundation for these protections as the JavaScript ecosystem evolves and would minimize the compatibility and performance issues stemming from the shim's fidelity.

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Problem statement review

We got Stage 1 for the following problem statement:

A way to evaluate a module and its dependencies in the context of a new global scope within the same Realm

Aiming to achieve it by severing the tie to the `GlobalEnvironmentRecord` in `ModuleEnvironmentRecord` instances by allowing setting `[[OuterEnv]]` to a different record than `module.[[Realm]].[[GlobalEnv]]`, replacing it with user-defined emulation of a global.

Feedback addressed: No multiple Globals in one Realm

Scope Ceiling

16.2.1.7.3.1 InitializeEnvironment(.)

```
3. Let realm be module.[[Realm]].
4. Assert: realm is not undefined.
+ if module.[[ScopeCeiling]] is not EMPTY, then
+   Let outer be NewObjectEnvironment(module.[[ScopeCeiling]], false, null)
+   Let env be NewModuleEnvironment(outer)
+ Else
+   Let env be NewModuleEnvironment(realm.[[GlobalEnv]]).
5. Set module.[[Environment]] to env.
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note:

- `module` is Source Text Module Record
- `NewObjectEnvironment` could be called earlier
- `[[ScopeCeiling]]` might be accessed indirectly

Path to `[[ScopeCeiling]]`

The association between `ModuleRecord` and `ScopeCeiling` ultimately needs to be introduced by an intermediary - potentially the same intermediary that introduces `LoadedModules`. (like `Compartment`)

We initially considered associating `ScopeCeiling` with `ModuleSource` in its constructor. It doesn't compose well with the `esm-phase-imports` proposal anymore.

Execution Context interactions

Note: `module.[[Environment]]` becomes `LexicalEnvironment` of the `moduleContext`

11. Set the Realm of `moduleContext` to `module.[[Realm]]`.
12. Set the `ScriptOrModule` of `moduleContext` to `module`.
13. Set the `VariableEnvironment` of `moduleContext` to `module.[[Environment]]`.
14. Set the `LexicalEnvironment` of `moduleContext` to `module.[[Environment]]`.
15. Set the `PrivateEnvironment` of `moduleContext` to `null`.
16. Set `module.[[Context]]` to `moduleContext`.
17. Push `moduleContext` onto the execution context stack;
 `moduleContext` is now the running execution context.

Lookup

1. The `x` IdentifierReference is evaluated. Per [§13.1.3](#) (Runtime Semantics: Evaluation of IdentifierReference), calls `ResolveBinding("x")`.
2. `ResolveBinding` reads `env` from the **running execution context's LexicalEnvironment**. The running execution context is `module.[[Context]]`, and its `LexicalEnvironment` is the module's `ModuleEnvironmentRecord`. Since module code is always strict, `strict = true`. Calls `GetIdentifierReference(moduleEnv, "x", true)`.

Lookup

3. `GetIdentifierReference` calls `moduleEnv.HasBinding("x")` on the `ModuleEnvironmentRecord`. The module environment holds only the module's own top-level `var` / `let` / `const` / `class` declarations and imported bindings. `x` is none of these, so `HasBinding` returns **false**.
4. `GetIdentifierReference` reads `outer = moduleEnv.[[OuterEnv]]` reaching `ScopeCeiling`
5. `ScopeCeiling.[[OuterEnv]]` is null, so it cannot progress to Realm global for lookup

The change would result in an option to run a module in a context that does not have the means to reach globals lexically.

The *undeniables* would come from the shared Realm, convenience of accessing intrinsics lexically via their global name would depend on the provider of `ScopeCeiling` adding them.

Open questions

1. Is `NewModuleEnvironment` a spec fiction? Can we verify that `ModuleEnvironmentRecord` points to its `OuterEnv` explicitly as opposed to it being looked up by default in the end?
 - This [area in Firefox](#) seems related and [this line](#) looks like a match for spec setting `OuterEnv`
 - This [line in V8](#) mentions `outer` in the context of `ModuleContext` - might be related

Open questions

2. `ScopeCeiling` needs means to be associated with a module.
 - The Compartment proposal would define a common `ScopeCeiling` for all modules loaded in a `Compartment`
 - We are open to exploring exposing it independently of `Compartment`, as some of the motivating use-cases (e.g. DSLs) do not require an `importHook` to also be present.
 - Is `import('specifier', { scope: {} })` an option?
 - An entity encapsulating a pair: `ModuleSource`, `ScopeCeiling` and also be acceptable as input wherever `ModuleSource` is?

Thank you